

Artha-Niti

The Indic Tradition of Wealth, Polity, and Prudence

BharatVidya · BORI Lecture Series

100 Multiple Choice Questions

Q1. How many dhana-nama (names of wealth) does the Nighantu 2.10 enumerate?

- A) Eighteen
- B) Twenty-eight
- C) Thirty-two
- D) Forty

Answer: B — Nighantu 2.10 lists twenty-eight dhana-nama including magham, dravinam, rayi, and others.

Q2. The Vedic term 'magha' denotes wealth from the standpoint of:

- A) Hoarding
- B) Donation
- C) Conquest
- D) Inheritance

Answer: B — Magha derives from the root mamh meaning the act of donation; deities like Indra are called maghavat.

Q3. According to the Vedic lecture, which two social perspectives on wealth emerge from magha-rayi versus dravina?

- A) Spiritual versus material
- B) Wealth oriented to others versus wealth oriented to oneself
- C) Agricultural versus commercial
- D) Royal versus common

Answer: B — Magha and rayi rest on the donation aspect (oriented to others), while dravina rests on the desire aspect (oriented to oneself).

Q4. According to the Gautama Dharmasutra, the legal rate of interest is:

- A) 3 mashas a month for twenty
- B) 5 mashas a month for twenty
- C) 10 mashas a month for twenty
- D) 7 mashas a month for twenty

Answer: B — Gautama Dharmasutra documents that the legal rate of interest is 5 mashas a month for twenty.

Q5. The shad-bhaga principle of Baudhyana Dharmasutra 1.18.1 establishes that the king shall raise what fraction as tax?

- A) One-tenth
- B) One-eighth
- C) One-sixth
- D) One-fourth

Answer: C — Shadbhagabhrito raja rakshet prajah — the king who raises one-sixth as tax shall protect the people in return.

Q6. What is a 'putrika' in Dharmasutra terminology?

- A) A woman who rules as regent
- B) An appointed daughter whose son inherits her father's wealth
- C) A female ascetic who renounces property
- D) A wife who manages her husband's estate

Answer: B — When a man has no son, he may appoint his daughter (putrika) so that her son becomes successor to her father's wealth.

Q7. Apastamba Dharmasutra 2.25.10-11 states that a ruler shall not live more lavishly than:

- A) The common people
- B) The elders and the ministers
- C) The priests and scholars
- D) His predecessors on the throne

Answer: B — The ruler shall not live more lavishly than the elders and ministers, and no one in his kingdom shall die from hunger, illness, cold, or heat.

Q8. The Vedic cosmic foundation for the worldly concept of danda rests on which deity's enforcement of cosmic law?

- A) Indra
- B) Agni
- C) Varuna
- D) Surya

Answer: C — Varuna follows the cosmic law rita unfailingly and punishes those who break it, providing the foundation for worldly danda.

Q9. Which Dharmasutra prescribes that artisans shall do one day's work monthly for the king, and the king must feed them while they work?

- A) Vasishtha
- B) Baudhyana
- C) Apastamba
- D) Gautama

Answer: D — Gautama Dharmasutra 10.31 states each artisan shall do one day's work monthly for the king, who must feed them.

Q10. According to the Vedic lecture, which four components of political administration are identifiable in the initial Vedic texts?

- A) King, army, fort, treasury
- B) King, ministers, family, subjects
- C) King, priest, commander, spy
- D) King, law, land, people

Answer: B — The initial Vedic components are: King, ministers, family, and subjects, along with spies, assemblies, and strategies.

Q11. According to Vasishtha Dharmasutra, a son was NOT bound to repay which of these types of paternal debt?

- A) Debts from trade
- B) Debts from agriculture
- C) Debts arising from gambling or drinking
- D) Debts from land purchases

Answer: C — Sons were not bound to repay debts undertaken as surety, debts promised in vain, debts from gambling or drinking, or unpaid portions of fines/taxes.

Q12. The Valmiki Ramayana is designated as a(n):

- A) Itihasa-purana
- B) Arsha-mahakavya
- C) Dharmashastra
- D) Nitishastra

Answer: B — The Valmiki Ramayana is designated an arsha-mahakavya — a divine composition originating from a seer (rishi).

Q13. In Arthashastra 15.1.1, Kautilya defines artha as:

- A) The pursuit of dharma through wealth
- B) The livelihood of people and the earth with its inhabitants
- C) Gold, silver, and precious metals
- D) The king's personal treasury

Answer: B — Lokanam vrittih arthah — artha is the livelihood of people; manushyavati bhumih iti arthah — artha is the earth with its inhabitants.

Q14. Which of Dasharatha's eight ministers is designated 'arthavit' (knower of artha)?

- A) Dhrishti
- B) Vijaya
- C) Dharmapala
- D) Sumantra

Answer: D — Sumantra, the eighth minister, is designated arthavit — the minister specialised in economic and political affairs.

Q15. In the kaccit-prashna, Rama states that the root of kings' victory is:

- A) Kosha (treasury)
- B) Danda (punishment)
- C) Mantra (counsel)
- D) Sena (army)

Answer: C — Mantra vijaya-mulam hi rajnam bhavati — mantra (counsel), when well-guarded, is the root of kings' victory.

Q16. According to Ramayana 2.100.32-33, delayed payment of military rations and wages produces:

- A) Minor inconvenience
- B) An anartha of the highest magnitude
- C) Temporary dissatisfaction
- D) A need for renegotiation

Answer: B — Soldiers enraged by delayed compensation produce an anartha of the highest magnitude — it is a security necessity.

Q17. Which qualities does Rama specify for a duta (ambassador) in the kaccit-prashna?

- A) Brave, strong, fearless, wealthy
- B) Learned, clever, quick-witted, one who reports exactly what he was told
- C) Noble-born, pious, aged, experienced
- D) Multilingual, well-travelled, physically imposing

Answer: B — The duta must be janapada, vidvan, dakshina, pratibhanavat, yathoktavadi, and pandita.

Q18. The daiva-manusha framework in the Arthashastra distinguishes between:

- A) Divine law and human law
- B) The unseen effect of past karma and the effect of deliberate human action
- C) Celestial omens and terrestrial calculations
- D) Priestly rituals and royal commands

Answer: B — Daiva is the effect of the unseen (past karma); manusha is deliberate human action yielding naya or apanaya.

Q19. The Ramayana's kaccit-prashna specifies how many classes of spies in the enemy camp?

- A) Ten
- B) Twelve
- C) Fifteen
- D) Eighteen

Answer: D — Rama asks about eighteen classes of spies among others, fifteen in one's own party, sent in groups of three unknown to one another.

Q20. The Mahabharata compares the interdependence of Dharma and Artha to:

- A) The sun and the moon
- B) The oceans and the rain-bearing clouds
- C) A tree and its roots
- D) Fire and fuel

Answer: B — Artha is inherent to Dharma and Dharma depends on Artha, just as oceans and rain-bearing clouds are interdependent.

Q21. In the Mahabharata, the terms kshayam and vriddhim refer to:

- A) War and peace
- B) Depreciation/loss of assets and maintenance/growth through upkeep
- C) Import and export
- D) Taxation and exemption

Answer: B — Kshayam means depreciation and loss of assets; vriddhim means maintenance through proper upkeep and acquisition of new capacities.

Q22. The Mahabharata compares money begetting money to:

- A) Seeds producing trees
- B) Wild elephants captured with the help of domesticated elephants
- C) Rivers merging into the ocean
- D) Fire spreading through forests

Answer: B — Money put to wise uses begets more money, just as wild elephants may be captured with help of domesticated elephants.

Q23. Which four metaphors does the Mahabharata use for the proper mode of tax collection?

- A) Lion, eagle, serpent, and ant
- B) Bee collecting honey, bee building reserves, leech drawing blood, tigress carrying cubs
- C) Farmer sowing, shepherd herding, potter shaping, weaver threading
- D) Rain falling, river flowing, sun warming, wind blowing

Answer: B — Bee (collect without damaging), bee slowly (build reserves), leech (draw gently), tigress (firm but no injury).

Q24. The Mahabharata prescribes that when a rise in tax rates is necessary, it should be done:

- A) All at once to avoid uncertainty
- B) Only in wartime
- C) Gradually, at a slowly increasing rate
- D) Only with priestly approval

Answer: C — Payable taxes should be imposed at a slowly increasing rate, little by little, and only gradually made heavier.

Q25. In the Shadja Gita, Arjuna identifies which four activities as the principal means for attaining artha?

- A) Yajna, tapa, dana, dhyana
- B) Krishi, vanijya, goraksha, and shilpa
- C) Mining, trade, conquest, and lending
- D) Teaching, healing, crafting, and farming

Answer: B — Arjuna names krishi (agriculture), vanijya (trade), goraksha (cattle-rearing), and shilpa (crafts) as principal means.

Q26. Nakula and Sahadeva's injunction 'artha-yogam dridham kuryat' means:

- A) One should practice yoga for wealth
- B) One should firmly establish the attainment of artha at all times
- C) One should renounce artha for dharma
- D) One should invest only in land

Answer: B — Whether seated, lying, moving, or standing — one should consistently consider how artha-attainment may be strengthened.

Q27. The Utathya Gita uses the cow-and-calf metaphor to illustrate:

- A) The relationship between king and heir
- B) Proper and improper taxation of the people
- C) The bond between guru and shishya
- D) Agricultural best practices

Answer: B — The rashtra is compared to a cow; excessive taxation (milking) weakens the people (calf); moderation ensures both thrive.

Q28. The Kalaka-vrikshiya Gita's episode of testing ministers corresponds to which later Arthashastra concept?

- A) Saptanga theory
- B) Mandala theory
- C) Arthopadha and kamopadha (integrity tests for ministers)
- D) Shadgunya (six foreign policies)

Answer: C — The narrative is an earlier form of what receives systematic expression as arthopadha and kamopadha in the Arthashastra.

Q29. How many nyayya (legitimate) means of acquiring wealth does the Hamsa Gita enumerate?

- A) Five
- B) Seven
- C) Ten
- D) Twelve

Answer: B — Seven: daya (inheritance), labha (gifts), kraya (purchase/sale), jaya (victory), prayoga, karma-yoga (labour), sat-pratigraha.

Q30. In the Hamsa Gita, the distinction between 'bhriti' and 'seva' is:

- A) Bhriti is teaching; seva is learning
- B) Bhriti is daily/periodic wage labour; seva is sustained ongoing service
- C) Bhriti is royal; seva is common
- D) Bhriti is agricultural; seva is commercial

Answer: B — Bhriti is wage-based labour for daily/periodic remuneration; seva is stable, ongoing engagement exchanging skills for compensation.

Q31. The five defining characteristics (panchalakshana) of a Purana include sarga, pratisarga, vamsha, manvantara, and:

- A) Vamshanukirtana
- B) Vamshaanucharita
- C) Vamshapravartana
- D) Vamshasthiti

Answer: B — The five are: sarga, pratisarga, vamsha, manvantara, and vamshaanucharita (narratives of great lineage figures).

Q32. The term 'hina-mulya balat-krita' in the Hamsa Gita refers to:

- A) Charitable giving at reduced price
- B) Acquiring goods at below-fair price by force against the seller's will
- C) Government-fixed pricing
- D) Barter exchange

Answer: B — Giving hina-mulya (lower than appropriate price) and acquiring by force (balat) makes the transaction sa-dosha and dushkritya.

Q33. Which Purana provides the panchalakshana formulation of the defining characteristics?

- A) Bhagavata Purana
- B) Vishnu Purana
- C) Matsya Purana
- D) Vayu Purana

Answer: B — The Vishnu Purana preserves the formulation: sarga, pratisarga, vamsha, manvantarani, vamshaanucharita.

Q34. The Sukra-niti is attributed to:

- A) Brihaspati

- B) Kamandaka
- C) Shukracharya
- D) Bhartrihari

Answer: C — The Sukra-niti is the niti text attributed to Shukracharya, the preceptor of the asuras.

Q35. According to the Sukra-niti, what is the king's primary duty?

- A) Conquest of neighbouring kingdoms
- B) Performance of elaborate rituals
- C) Protection and welfare of subjects
- D) Accumulation of personal wealth

Answer: C — Sukra-niti emphasizes the king's primary duty as the protection and welfare of subjects through just governance.

Q36. According to the course, how many lectures are devoted to Kautilya's Arthashastra?

- A) Four
- B) Five
- C) Six
- D) Eight

Answer: C — The course devotes six lectures to the Arthashastra, covering four sciences, king formation, superintendents, saptanga, and legacy.

Q37. In the Arthashastra, 'Anvikshiki' refers to:

- A) The science of agriculture
- B) The science of reasoning or critical inquiry
- C) The science of warfare
- D) The science of ritual

Answer: B — Anvikshiki is the science of reasoning or critical inquiry — the philosophical foundation supporting the other three sciences.

Q38. The 'Trayi' in the Arthashastra's four sciences refers to:

- A) The three Vedas (Rig, Yajur, Sama)
- B) The three purushartha minus moksha
- C) The three types of fortification
- D) The three economic activities

Answer: A — Trayi refers to the three Vedas — Rig, Yajur, and Sama — representing the Vedic knowledge tradition.

Q39. Kautilya declares 'artha eva pradhanah' meaning:

- A) Dharma is the foremost pursuit
- B) Artha alone is the principal pursuit
- C) Kama is the highest goal
- D) Moksha supersedes everything

Answer: B — Kautilya asserts artha eva pradhanah — artha is the principal pursuit, as dharma and kama have their root in artha.

Q40. The Arthashastra's mandala theory describes a circle of how many components of states?

- A) Seven

- B) Ten
- C) Twelve
- D) Sixteen

Answer: C — The prakriti-mandalam consists of twelve components in the circle of states surrounding the vijigishu.

Q41. The six inner enemies that the prince must conquer according to the Arthashastra are kama, krodha, lobha, mana, mada, and:

- A) Bhaya
- B) Harsha
- C) Shoka
- D) Moha

Answer: B — The six are kama, krodha, lobha, mana, mada, and harsha — identical to the Ramayana's indriya-jaya list.

Q42. In the Arthashastra, 'Dandaniti' refers to:

- A) The science of punishment only
- B) The science of governance, administration, and enforcement
- C) Military tactics exclusively
- D) The science of diplomacy

Answer: B — Dandaniti is the science of governance — it encompasses administration, law enforcement, and the proper use of coercive power.

Q43. Which term does Kautilya use for the concept of 'acquisition and preservation' of wealth?

- A) Dharma-artha
- B) Yoga-kshema
- C) Naya-apanaya
- D) Sama-bheda

Answer: B — Yoga-kshema means acquisition (yoga) and preservation (kshema) of wealth — the yield of right policy (naya).

Q44. The Arthashastra's saptanga (seven limbs of the state) includes svami, amatya, janapada, durga, kosha, danda, and:

- A) Dharma
- B) Purohita
- C) Mitra
- D) Senapati

Answer: C — The seven elements are svami (king), amatya (minister), janapada (territory/people), durga (fort), kosha (treasury), danda (army), mitra (ally).

Q45. In the Bruhatkatha-Manjari, the principal political theme involves:

- A) Maritime trade routes
- B) The adventures and political wisdom embedded in narrative tales
- C) Military conquest strategies
- D) Temple administration

Answer: B — The Bruhatkatha-Manjari presents political wisdom through narrative tales, combining entertainment with niti instruction.

Q46. According to the Bruhatkatha-Manjari lecture, what is the relationship between artha and niti in narrative literature?

- A) They are unrelated
- B) Niti principles are embedded within entertaining narratives to educate readers
- C) Artha contradicts niti
- D) Only niti matters; artha is secondary

Answer: B — Narrative literature embeds niti principles within stories, making political and economic wisdom accessible through entertainment.

Q47. The Panchatantra is traditionally attributed to:

- A) Kautilya
- B) Vishnu Sharma
- C) Bhartrihari
- D) Kamandaka

Answer: B — The Panchatantra is attributed to Vishnu Sharma, who composed it to educate the dull princes of a king.

Q48. The Panchatantra is divided into how many tantras (books)?

- A) Three
- B) Four
- C) Five
- D) Seven

Answer: C — Pancha-tantra literally means five books or treatises, each teaching a different aspect of niti through animal fables.

Q49. The second tantra of the Panchatantra, 'Mitrasamprapti' or 'Mitralabha,' deals with:

- A) Warfare
- B) The gaining of friends and allies
- C) Taxation
- D) Administration

Answer: B — Mitrasamprapti/Mitralabha teaches the gaining of friends — how alliances form through mutual benefit and trust.

Q50. In the Kamasutra, Vatsyayana discusses the concept of the 'nagaraka.' Who is the nagaraka?

- A) A rural farmer
- B) An idealized urbane gentleman versed in sixty-four arts
- C) A wandering ascetic
- D) A military commander

Answer: B — The nagaraka is the idealized city-dweller, a cultured gentleman who masters the sixty-four kalas (arts) and lives with refinement.

Q51. Vatsyayana's view on the relationship between dharma, artha, and kama is that:

- A) Kama is superior to both dharma and artha
- B) All three should be pursued in balance without one overriding the others
- C) Only dharma matters
- D) Artha should always take precedence

Answer: B — Vatsyayana advocates that dharma, artha, and kama should be pursued in balance — each has its proper sphere and time.

Q52. According to the Kamasutra lecture, which of these economic themes does Vatsyayana address?

- A) International trade routes
- B) The lifestyle, expenditure, and revenue management of the nagaraka
- C) Military budgets
- D) Temple economics

Answer: B — The Kamasutra addresses the nagaraka's daily lifestyle, expenditure patterns, and the management of resources for cultured living.

Q53. In Jain literature, which concept emphasizes non-possession or non-attachment to material wealth?

- A) Ahimsa
- B) Aparigraha
- C) Anekantavada
- D) Syadvada

Answer: B — Aparigraha is the Jain principle of non-possession or non-attachment, limiting accumulation of wealth to what is needed.

Q54. The Jain concept of 'samyak charitra' (right conduct) includes:

- A) Only meditation and fasting
- B) Ethical earning, honest commerce, and proper use of wealth
- C) Military discipline
- D) Ritualistic worship exclusively

Answer: B — Right conduct in Jainism encompasses ethical earning, honest commercial practices, and the proper use of wealth alongside spiritual discipline.

Q55. In Jain literature, the concept of 'dravya' refers to:

- A) Money only
- B) Substance or reality — the fundamental categories of existence
- C) Trade goods
- D) Agricultural produce

Answer: B — Dravya in Jain philosophy refers to the fundamental substances or categories of existence, not merely material wealth.

Q56. In Buddhist literature, the concept of 'samma ajiva' refers to:

- A) Right meditation
- B) Right livelihood — earning through ethical means
- C) Right speech
- D) Right effort

Answer: B — Samma ajiva (right livelihood) is part of the Noble Eightfold Path, requiring that one earns through ethical and non-harmful means.

Q57. The Sigalovada Sutta addresses:

- A) Monastic discipline

- B) The duties of a householder including financial management and social obligations
- C) Meditation techniques
- D) Cosmological questions

Answer: B — The Sigalovada Sutta is the 'householder's vinaya,' laying out duties including financial management and social relationships.

Q58. In Buddhist economic thought, the five trades prohibited for a lay follower include trade in weapons, living beings, meat, intoxicants, and:

- A) Gold
- B) Poison
- C) Silk
- D) Salt

Answer: B — The five prohibited trades are: weapons, living beings, meat, intoxicants, and poison — all causing harm to sentient beings.

Q59. In the Jataka Tales, niti and artha themes frequently appear through:

- A) Abstract philosophical discourse
- B) Narrative episodes where the Bodhisattva demonstrates wise governance and economic prudence
- C) Ritual descriptions
- D) Astronomical calculations

Answer: B — Jataka Tales embed niti and artha teachings through narratives where the Bodhisattva exemplifies wise governance and prudence.

Q60. The Jataka Tales' treatment of trade and commerce reflects:

- A) Hostility to commercial activity
- B) Recognition of trade as a legitimate and important livelihood requiring ethical conduct
- C) Indifference to economic matters
- D) Exclusive focus on agriculture

Answer: B — The Jataka Tales recognise trade as legitimate and important, while emphasising ethical conduct in commercial dealings.

Q61. In the Arthashastra, the duties of the Sitadhyaksha include oversight of:

- A) Military operations
- B) Crown lands, seed distribution, irrigation, and agricultural production
- C) Temple revenues
- D) Maritime trade

Answer: B — The Sitadhyaksha oversees crown agricultural lands, distribution of seed, irrigation infrastructure, and production records.

Q62. KA 2.36 of the Arthashastra covers the charter of which official?

- A) Sitadhyaksha
- B) Nagaradhyaksha (Superintendent of the City)
- C) Kosha-adhyaksha
- D) Panya-adhyaksha

Answer: B — KA 2.36 deals with the Nagaradhyaksha — the Superintendent of the City and urban administration.

Q63. According to the Arthashastra, KA 6.1-6.2 discusses:

- A) Agricultural policy
- B) The seven elements of sovereignty (saptanga) and the vijigishu
- C) Tax collection methods
- D) Espionage techniques

Answer: B — KA 6.1-6.2 presents the seven-limbed theory of the state and the concept of the vijigishu (conqueror-king).

Q64. The term 'kosha' in the saptanga theory refers to:

- A) The fort
- B) The treasury
- C) The army
- D) The territory

Answer: B — Kosha is the treasury — one of the seven essential limbs of the state alongside svami, amatya, janapada, durga, danda, and mitra.

Q65. The six aspects of foreign policy (shadgunya) in the Arthashastra include sandhi (peace), vigraha (war), asana (staying neutral), yana (marching), samshraya (seeking protection), and:

- A) Dana (gift)
- B) Dvaidhibhava (dual policy — peace with one, war with another)
- C) Bheda (division)
- D) Danda (punishment)

Answer: B — The six foreign policies are: sandhi, vigraha, asana, yana, samshraya, and dvaidhibhava (dual policy).

Q66. The Mahabharata's principle on forward-looking accounting states that present expenditure resulting in permanent future increase of assets should be treated as:

- A) A loss
- B) Not an expense but an investment
- C) A tax obligation
- D) An emergency fund

Answer: B — Present expenditure that results in permanent increase of future assets should not be treated as an expense but as beneficial investment.

Q67. In the Mahabharata, the punishment for failing to renovate worn-out buildings is:

- A) Dismissal from office
- B) Double the punishment for non-performance of renewal work
- C) Confiscation of property
- D) Exile

Answer: B — Those who fail to accomplish renovation of worn-out buildings should face double the punishment for non-performance.

Q68. The Mahabharata states that a king who takes one-sixth of produce as tax but fails in protection acquires:

- A) Half the merit of his subjects
- B) One-fourth of the vices of the people
- C) Double the dharma

D) No consequence

Answer: B — The king who takes one-sixth as tax acquires one-fourth of the vices of the people if he fails in his protective duty.

Q69. Ramayana 2.100.56-57 articulates the principle that judicial process must ensure:

- A) All accused are punished
- B) Neither false conviction of the innocent nor false acquittal of the guilty
- C) Only the king may judge
- D) Punishment is always monetary

Answer: B — Neither an innocent noble should be killed through false accusation, nor a caught thief released through bribery — symmetric justice.

Q70. The phrase 'sone ki chidiya' (land of gold) attributed to India is connected in the Gita lecture to:

- A) India's gold mines
- B) The balanced integration of all four purusharthas
- C) India's climate
- D) India's military power

Answer: B — India was known as sone ki chidiya precisely because of the balanced integration of dharma, artha, kama, and moksha.

Q71. In the Utathya Gita, 'paurajanapada' refers to:

- A) Only rural populations
- B) Both urban and rural populations
- C) Only city dwellers
- D) Foreign settlers

Answer: B — Paurajanapada refers to both urban (paura) and rural (janapada) populations whose welfare must be ensured.

Q72. The Kalaka-vrikshiya Gita distinguishes between 'santosha' and 'alpa-santosha' to teach that:

- A) One should always be minimally content
- B) Genuine satisfaction must not become an excuse for inertia
- C) Contentment means accepting poverty
- D) All desires should be eliminated

Answer: B — Santosha is genuine satisfaction with what is attained; alpa-santosha is mere minimal contentment — the former must not justify stopping all effort.

Q73. The Hamsa Gita chapter on 'sambhuya-samutthana' corresponds to the modern concept of:

- A) Sole proprietorship
- B) Partnership and joint enterprise
- C) Government monopoly
- D) International trade

Answer: B — Sambhuya-samutthana refers to joint enterprise corresponding to partnership ventures with equitable sharing of profits and losses.

Q74. According to the course overview, how many lectures comprise the Artha-Niti course?

- A) Eighteen
- B) Twenty
- C) Twenty-two
- D) Twenty-four

Answer: C — The course is a twenty-two lecture course on the classical Indian political and economic tradition.

Q75. The IAST system used for Sanskrit transliteration stands for:

- A) Indian Academy of Sanskrit Translation
- B) International Alphabet of Sanskrit Transliteration
- C) Indo-Aryan Standard Transliteration
- D) Institute for Ancient Sanskrit Texts

Answer: B — IAST stands for International Alphabet of Sanskrit Transliteration, adding diacritical marks for precise representation.

Q76. The Mahabharata observes that forest-dwellers who collect fruit, honey, and medicines should be:

- A) Taxed at higher rates
- B) Exempted from all taxes
- C) Taxed at moderate rates as in the past
- D) Relocated to cities

Answer: C — Forest workers may destroy resources if mistreated, so they should be taxed at moderate rates as before.

Q77. The Vedic term 'adhi' refers to:

- A) A type of tax
- B) Collateral pledged against a loan
- C) A religious offering
- D) An inheritance share

Answer: B — Adhi is collateral — the pledged object secured against a loan in the Vedic lending system.

Q78. The Sri-sukta praising Lakshmi/Shri is a later supplementary part of which Veda?

- A) Yajurveda
- B) Rigveda
- C) Atharvaveda
- D) Samaveda

Answer: B — The Sri-sukta praising the goddess with gold, elephants, horses, and cows is a later supplementary part of the Rigveda.

Q79. In the Shadja Gita, 'arthabhava' (absence of artha) is described as the root cause of:

- A) Spiritual liberation
- B) Asantosha (dissatisfaction) and atripti (unfulfillment)
- C) Political stability
- D) Moksha attainment

Answer: B — Where artha is absent, even cherished objects diminish and desires remain unfulfilled — arthabhava causes asantoshā and atīpti.

Q80. In the Ramayana's kaccit-prashna, the term 'apatra' refers to:

- A) Empty vessels
- B) The unworthy — those to whom the treasury must never flow
- C) Foreign merchants
- D) Soldiers without weapons

Answer: B — Apatra means the unworthy — Rama asks whether the treasury flows to such persons, establishing fiscal discipline.

Q81. The Vishnu Dharmasutra prescribes that if a group conspires to kill a single person, the punishment shall be:

- A) The same as for an individual
- B) Double that given to an individual for the same offence
- C) Half that for an individual
- D) Only a fine

Answer: B — The Vishnu Dharmasutra states that group conspiracy punishment shall be double that for an individual committing the same offence.

Q82. In the Ramayana, the term 'vimsati-varga' refers to:

- A) Twenty types of taxes
- B) Twenty kinds of rulers unsuitable for alliance
- C) Twenty kinds of fortifications
- D) Twenty types of soldiers

Answer: B — Vimsati-varga denotes the twenty kinds of rulers unsuitable for alliance in the political classification scheme.

Q83. The Arthashastra's concept of 'upadha' testing of ministers involves tests of:

- A) Physical strength and endurance
- B) Integrity through dharma, artha, kama, and bhaya (fear) temptations
- C) Scholarly knowledge only
- D) Military skill

Answer: B — Ministers are tested through dharmopadha, arthopadha, kamopadha, and bhayopadha — temptations of righteousness, wealth, desire, and fear.

Q84. The Ramayana specifies that servants should be assigned to offices based on:

- A) Seniority alone
- B) Great to great, middle to middle, lowest to lowest duties
- C) Random rotation
- D) Birth order

Answer: B — At 2.100.25, Rama asks whether great servants are assigned to great offices, middle to middle, and lowest to lowest.

Q85. The Sarama-Pani katha from Vedic literature relates to:

- A) A marriage ritual
- B) A narrative about traders and wealth cited among components of political administration

- C) A hymn to the sun
- D) An agricultural prayer

Answer: B — The Sarama-Pani katha is a Vedic narrative cited among the components of political administration.

Q86. In the Vedic lecture, 'bhaga' literally means:

- A) Fortune
- B) A share in the wealth
- C) A prayer
- D) A sacrifice

Answer: B — Bhaga literally means a share in the wealth; hence bhagya means fortune — the fortune that comes with that share.

Q87. According to the Vedic lecture, which metals are mentioned in the Vedic texts?

- A) Gold, silver, copper, and tin
- B) Gold (hiranya), silver (rajata), iron (shyama), and copper (loha)
- C) Gold, bronze, lead, and zinc
- D) Silver, platinum, tin, and iron

Answer: B — Precious metals mentioned include hiranya (gold), rajata (silver), shyama (iron), and loha (copper).

Q88. The Mahabharata prescribes that the king should acquire what he has not yet acquired, increase what he has, and:

- A) Hoard the rest
- B) Distribute the excess to appropriate recipients according to prescribed rules
- C) Spend it all on defence
- D) Give it to priests

Answer: B — The three-step principle: acquire what is unacquired, increase what is already acquired, and distribute excess per prescribed rules.

Q89. The concept of 'ganatantra' mentioned in the Kalaka-vrikshiya Gita refers to:

- A) A monarchy
- B) A republican polity
- C) A theocracy
- D) An oligarchy

Answer: B — Ganatantra refers to a republican polity — Kalaka-vrikshiya instructs on its form and preservation alongside niti.

Q90. The Ramayana verse stating that Ayodhya had 'water sweet as sugarcane juice' (1.5.17) is part of the description of:

- A) The king's palace
- B) The ideal urban polity with abundant provision
- C) A ritual offering
- D) A market description

Answer: B — Verse 1.5.17 describes houses dense and gap-free, built on even ground, full of rice, with water sweet as sugarcane juice.

Q91. The Arthashastra identifies the king's daily regimen as divided into how many parts?

- A) Four
- B) Six
- C) Eight
- D) Sixteen

Answer: C — The king's day is divided into eight nalikas (time divisions), each assigned specific administrative and personal duties.

Q92. In the Ramayana, ministers who have passed 'upadha' tests are described as:

- A) Amatyan upadhatitan — above tests of temptation
- B) Amatyan yoga-yuktan — absorbed in meditation
- C) Amatyan danda-dharin — wielders of punishment
- D) Amatyan krishi-nipunan — skilled in farming

Answer: A — At 2.100.26, Rama says ministers must be amatyan upadhatitan — above tests of temptation, of established trustworthy lineage.

Q93. The Gautama Dharmasutra states that the king shall be 'samah prajasu,' meaning:

- A) The king shall be wealthy
- B) The king shall treat all people equally
- C) The king shall be powerful
- D) The king shall be scholarly

Answer: B — The king shall be correct in actions and speech, educated, pure, self-controlled, and above all treat all people equally.

Q94. In the Vedic judicial system, the term 'pradvivaka' refers to:

- A) A plaintiff
- B) A judge
- C) A defendant
- D) A lawyer

Answer: B — Pradvivaka is another term for a judge; witnesses appear before the pradvivaka, and truth-speaking before him is the foremost duty.

Q95. In the Gita lecture, the phrase 'arthasiddhya vinivrittau' means:

- A) When artha is renounced, dharma is attained
- B) Once artha has been attained, the other purusharthas naturally follow
- C) Artha prevents moksha
- D) Only siddhas can attain artha

Answer: B — Arthasiddhya vinivrittau — once artha is attained, the acquisition of dharma and kama naturally follows.

Q96. The Buddhist concept of dividing income into four parts allocates two parts to:

- A) Religious donations
- B) Business investment
- C) Daily consumption
- D) Military contribution

Answer: B — The Buddha's fourfold division: one part for daily needs, two parts for business investment, and one part saved for emergencies.

Q97. The course identifies which of the following as a learning outcome for students?

- A) Ability to read Sanskrit fluently
- B) Ability to deploy the Kautilyan framework of saptanga, mandala, danda, and vijigishu as analytical tools
- C) Ability to perform Vedic rituals
- D) Ability to compose poetry in Sanskrit

Answer: B — Students will be able to deploy the Kautilyan framework of saptanga, mandala, danda, and vijigishu as analytical tools.

Q98. The Mahabharata's 'bee and flower' metaphor for taxation teaches that:

- A) All wealth belongs to the king
- B) Taxes should be collected without distorting the basis of production
- C) Only honey producers should be taxed
- D) The king should collect taxes personally

Answer: B — As the bee collects honey without disturbing the flower, the king should collect taxes without distorting economic production.

Q99. The Arthashastra's Part 1 lecture covers KA 1.2-1.3, which deals with:

- A) Military formations
- B) The Four Sciences and the Trayi
- C) Urban administration
- D) Espionage methods

Answer: B — KA 1.2-1.3 covers the fourfold division of sciences: Anvikshiki, Trayi, Vartta, and Dandaniti.

Q100. The Vedic term 'ratna-dhatamam' is explained by the Nighantu as:

- A) The rarest form of wealth
- B) The most giving of the beautiful and coveted forms of wealth
- C) The heaviest metal
- D) The king's personal jewels

Answer: B — Nighantu 7.15 explains ratna-dhatamam as the most giving of the beautiful, coveted forms of wealth.